Brunel University London Pathway College – Computer Science

Assessment C – Group Project Review

NC1605 Group Project Lectures & Tutorials

Table of Contents

Main Objective 1
Description of the Assessment 1
Learning Outcomes and Marking Criteria 6
Format Of The Assessments 6
Submission Instructions 7
Avoiding Academic Misconduct 7
Expectations Of Artificial Intelligence Use 7
Late Coursework 8

Assessment Title	Group Project Review
Module Leader	Dr Zear Ibrahim
Distribution Date	Week 3
Submission Deadline	Week 7 (Plan) Week 23-24 (Presentation + Code Integration)
Feedback by	Week 30
Contribution to overall module assessment	25%
Indicate student time working on assessment	100 Hours
Word or Page limit (if applicable)	Plan: 10 Pages (not including cover page and references)
Assessment Type (Individual or group)	Plan (Group) Presentation (Group)

Main Objective

The aim of this assignment is to encourage you and your team to plan your first-year work (0%) and to review and reflect on your activities within the Group Project module (25%). Together, this contributes 25% to the NC1605 module block and will be assessed by your tutor.

Description of the Assessment

This assignment is divided into two separate coursework pieces:

1. Group Plan (Formative - 0%)

You and your group should prepare a written report (referred to as the 'Plan') about planning your Year 1 work (NC1605, NC1606, NC1609, NC1603 and NC1610).

- The Plan should not exceed 10 pages.
- The Plan is a formative task (not graded) and should be completed as a group task.
- The Plan should be presented to the tutor in Week 8 during your regular scheduled class.

Your group plan should consists of 6 sections including a detailed introduction and conclusion. Note that any tools presented below are examples and suitable alternatives can be included in the plan.

Introduction

The introduction should explain what the purpose of the plan is and give a brief introduction to each following section in the plan.

The report should include the following sections:

i. **Cover page** indicating the module code; module title; assignment code; assignment title; group name (e.g., Group A 05); name of your tutor; name and IDs of all group members

ii. **Introduction** indicating the purpose of the report and a brief description of the sections iii) – vii) as seen below.

iii. **Assessments**

- List all the required assessments for all Year 1 modules (formative and summative assignments, live demonstrations and oral examinations ('VIVAs'), written examinations, class tests, quizzes, presentations, etc.)

- You must include the following information for each assessment and it should be presented in a clear and concise way, using appropriate visualization method(s) (i.e. tables or chart).

Information required: module code, module name, assessment code, assessment name, number of credits, whether the assessment is compulsory/optional, whether the assessment is core/non-core, release date and submission date).

iv. **Planning**

- Create a plan that shows how you will complete the required tasks (i.e. assessments as defined in point iii) above) on time and prepare for them. The plan should be presented in a clear and visual way, using a Gantt chart. The plan should include all tasks, breaking them down if necessary and showing dependencies (if any). The estimates of duration and effort should be reasonable.
- Create a list of deliverables and milestones with the expected delivery date for tasks as required.
- Feel free to add notes, if necessary, to explain your assumptions or other elements in the charts. Omit irrelevant or redundant information.

v. **Monitoring**

- Explain how you will monitor your progress in completing the required tasks.
- List any tools and/or resources that may be useful in monitoring progress (scheduling activities, working with a groups, keeping track of deadlines, sharing content, planning your daily tasks, maintaining backups, communication with your group etc). These tools should be easily accessible to students (i.e. resources at Brunel or free tools)

vi. **Risks**

- Identify at least 10 different risks that may affect your plan (i.e. completing the assessments required for year 1) and discuss how you are going to mitigate these risks. Where applicable, your mitigation strategies should refer to university services (i.e. relevant contact details of the responsible personal/ services/ platforms) that would help you in managing the risks.

vii. **Group Contribution**

- For each member of the group, mention the role and main responsibilities carried out in their role, and contribution to creating 'The Plan' report. This should be presented in a clear and concise way, using appropriate visualization method(s) (i.e. tables or chart). viii.

viii. **Conclusion** provide a summary of the important information identified in sections iii) – vii), different tools and techniques that have been identified and applied through your planning.

Advice: You should use concepts and techniques covered in NC1605 lectures and tutorials, particularly, in relation to project, people, and time management. Since it is a group task, speak to your group members and consider solutions that can be applicable to different learning patterns of members in your group.

Additional research can be done on project management concepts. Harvard referencing must be used if external sources such as tools, websites, articles or books are used.

Since it is a group task, you should distribute the questions among the group members so each one of you gets an equal and significant amount of work. Please seek advice and guidance from your tutor when distributing tasks. More than one person may contribute towards answering a single question. The presentation of the report can be delivered by one or more group members. The presentation (walk through the document) should not exceed 20 minutes. Your tutor may ask questions during or at the end of the presentation.

2. Group Review/Presentation + Code Integration (100%)

'Post-mortem' reviews are performed by software engineering teams after the conclusion of a project to determine and analyse the successful and unsuccessful elements of the project. This presentation is a post-mortem review.

The presentation should focus on the group tasks that you will have completed this year, that is, the Plan, Design and Implementation of the final system to deliver the full functionality of the Management System whilst managing the inner functioning of the team with the given set of roles.

Group responses

You were given three group tasks; 'The Plan', 'Code Integration Task' and 'Group Project Presentation'.

The answers to the following questions should be based on the contributions (completing the task and effective functioning of the team) for these four tasks.

i. Considering the overall group performance (completion of tasks, communication and coordination throughout the year) provide brief answers to the following:

   a. How was the group organised (i.e. was there a hierarchy, were the roles fixed)?
   b. How many tasks did your group complete successfully? Mention the number of requirements completed as a percentage for each task.
   c. How were the meetings with the group members conducted, group's participation and how effective were the meetings in completing the group tasks?
   d. List any means or tools which the group have regularly used for collaborative working such as for communication, planning/ scheduling, file sharing, maintaining backups and etc.

ii. Explain in detail how the Code Integration Task was achieved in terms of

   a. technical (process, design and programming) work; and
   b. teamwork aspects such as leadership, communication and coordination.

   Note: If the integration was not implemented fully (that is, not every group member participated) or failed, a discussion 'why it failed' should also be provided.

Individual responses

iii. What was your contribution to each of the four group tasks (i.e. to complete the task)? If you did not contribute to a particular task, you should explain your reasons for not contributing and what would you do differently if you had a chance to do the piece over again. You need to provide evidence for any technical work (e.g. design diagrams, test case tables, and etc) you have carried out to complete the task.

iv. State your role and responsibilities in relation to the effective functioning of the team. Note: If you worked on different roles for each task, mention the role and responsibilities carried out for each task. You should provide evidence for any management work (e.g. planning, time management, coordination, and etc) you have carried out for the effective functioning of the team.

v. Briefly explain how you feel about your role.

   a. What is the favourite part of your role? Why do you like it?
   b. What is the least favourite part of your role? Why do you dislike it?

vi. What resources did you use while carrying out duties in you role? Which ones were especially helpful? Elaborate drawing examples from the work you carried out.

vii. What is the one soft skill you particularly want others to notice when they look at your performance in your role? Elaborate drawing examples from the work you carried out.

viii. Describe a challenging issue you faced when carrying out the responsibilities in your role. How did you resolve it, and what did you learn from the experience? Elaborate drawing examples from the work you carried out.

ix. As you reflect on your performance in your role, what's one thing that you would like to try to improve upon? Explain why do you want to improve it drawing examples from the work you carried out and how you intend to do that.

x. What is the most important piece of advice (or tip) you would want to give someone who would be taking your role? Why do you think it is important? Elaborate drawing examples from the work you carried out.

You will be individually assessed on your answers and contributions to the presentation

You must also provide evidence for your contribution (completing the task and effective functioning of the team). For example, if you mention a flow chart was created for the code integration task, the flow chart should be included in the presentation. If your role is resource manager, you need to show evidence of how you planned a particular task. It is recommended to present the progress of your group work to the tutor during tutor meetings. It would be yours and your group's responsibility to present the work progress during tutor meetings so your tutor is aware of your contributions for tasks.

Each individual response in the presentation should be clearly attributed to the group member to whom it originates. In other words, your tutor should be able to know 'who said what', in order to carry out the assessment of each group member individually.

The presentation should use slides (in PowerPoint or PDF) or any other visual aids. The presentation should not exceed 60 minutes. Your tutor may ask questions during or at the end of the presentation. At the end of the presentation, the group should demonstrate the Code Integration Task to the tutor, if the code integration feature has been accomplished.

Remember criticism should never be aimed at individuals but rather at processes, events and decisions. Similarly, personal comments about your group members or other groups are absolutely prohibited. You may cover additional points if they are relevant. Remember – the Group Project Review is all about reflection and self-evaluation. You should try to be concise and professional in your approach. Remember criticism should never be aimed at individuals but rather at processes, events and decisions. Similarly, personal comments about your group members or other groups are absolutely prohibited.

3. Ethical and Professional Behaviour (Pass or Fail)

You are expected to engage with your level 1 studies and to work with others in a professional and ethical manner.

In order to pass this assessment block, you must have at least **75% attendance in tutor meetings** and must have been deemed to have **demonstrated the principles of professional and ethical behaviour** in a group and departmental context to be evaluated by your tutor in order to pass this assessment block.

LEARNING OUTCOMES AND MARKING CRITERIA

In order to get a pass grade (D- or above) in this assignment, you must meet the learning outcomes below, that is, you must demonstrate ability to:

- LO3: Effectively present and communicate solutions.
- LO7: Reflect and learn from your group project experiences.
- LO8: Understand and apply the principles of professional and ethical behaviour in a group and departmental context

Assignment Element	Learning Outcome	Marking Criteria	Weighting
1. Group Presentation	LO3, LO7	Your grade will be based on the following aspects: i. Completeness of the content against the given requirements (see Group Review/Presentation + Code Integration (100%)). ii. Effectiveness and significance of individual contributions to the tasks. iii. Quality of analysis, discussion and reflection in the individual responses.	
2. Ethical and Professional Behaviour	LO8	You will pass this element, if you have: i. Achieved a Pass in the Initial Knowledge Assessment or engaged with the NC1605 module as defined by your module leader. ii. Contributed to the team, maintained a good attendance and actively participated in tutorials.	

FORMAT OF THE ASSESSMENTS

Plan

The submitted assignment should be in Word (docx) format no longer than 10 pages including the introduction and conclusion (not including references).

Group Project Review

The submission will be a set of slides in PowerPoint (pptx) format and the full code integration task in Eclipse (.ZIP) format. There is no limit on the number of slides, but it should take no longer than 30 minutes for a group to present their slides.

SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

Plan

You must submit your coursework as a Word file on Moodle by Week 7: 03/11/2023 at 23:59pm. Please submit your plan in the form <STUDENT ID>_NC1605_PLAN.pdf (where <STUDENT ID> is replaced with your student ID). For example, a student whose student ID is 0612345 would submit their plan with the file name 0612345_NC1605_PLAN.pdf.

Group Project Review

You must submit your coursework as a PowerPoint file and Eclipse ZIP file on Moodle by Week 23. Please submit your PowerPoint in the form <STUDENT ID>_NC1605_REVIEW.pdf (where <STUDENT ID> is replaced with your student ID). For example, a student whose student ID is 0612345 would submit their review with the file name 0612345_NC1605_REVIEW.pdf. Note that each group member must submit the same set of group's slides.

AVOIDING ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT

Before working on and then submitting your coursework, please ensure that you understand the meaning of plagiarism, collusion, and cheating (including contract cheating) and the seriousness of these offences. Academic misconduct is serious and being found guilty of it results in penalties that can reduce the class of your degree and may lead to you being expelled from the University. Information on what constitutes academic misconduct and the potential consequences for students can be found in Senate Regulation 6.

You may also find it useful to read this PowerPoint presentation which explains, in plain English, the different kinds of misconduct, how to avoid (even accidently) committing them, how we detect misconduct, and the common reasons that students give for engaging in such activities. If you are experiencing difficulties with any part of your studies, remember there is always help available:

Speak to your personal tutor. If you're not sure who your tutor is, please ask the academic services team at studentservices@pathway.brunel.ac.uk

Alternatively, if you prefer to speak to someone outside of the Department you can contact the Student Support and Welfare team.

EXPECTATIONS OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE USE

The University has general guidance on using artificial intelligence in your studies.

Using AI-generated content and presenting it as your original work in any form of assessment, be it formative or summative, is strictly prohibited.

Despite Generative AI offers many useful services such as information search and retrieval, concept explanations, grammar and writing enhancements and coding assistance, it is crucial to recognise its inherent limitations. For instance, responses generated by AI can be overly general, inaccurate, biased, or even fabricated. They often lack proper references and detailed insights and they may pose challenges in terms of intellectual property rights and data privacy. Misuse of Generative AI can lead to academic misconduct.

Should you have used any information generated by AI in your work, you must provide clear references to the AI tools used. To maintain the authenticity of your work, it is essential to keep regular communication with your tutor and consistently update them on your progress. In the event of any concerns regarding the integrity of your work, a viva voce examination may be scheduled for further evaluation.

LATE COURSEWORK

The clear expectation is that you will submit your coursework by the submission deadline stated in the study guide. In line with the University's policy on the late submission of coursework (revised in July 2016), coursework submitted up to 48 hours late will be accepted, but capped at a threshold pass (D- for undergraduate or C- for postgraduate). Work submitted over 48 hours after the stated deadline will automatically be given a fail grade (F).

Please refer to the Computer Science student information pages and the Coursework Submission Procedure on Moodle for more information on submitting late work, penalties applied and procedures in the case of Extenuating circumstance.